had scaled the walls of Jaunpur to rescue their mother – made a furious charge at Akbar's archers. He was going strong until his horse was wounded and, rearing up in pain,[83] threw Bahadur to the ground.

Meanwhile, in another part of the battlefield, two of Akbar's elephants were settling a personal score – one of the hazards, it seems, of taking musth elephants into war. Chitranand charged at Gaj Bhaunr. The latter's mahout was a man of quick wit, however; he drove Gaj Bhaunr into enemy ranks, where his getaway would be of greater service to Akbar's army. Thus it was that Chitranand, racing behind, came face to face with an Uzbek elephant called Avidya. Impatient, perhaps, with the stranger coming between him and his feud with Gaj Bhaunr, Chitranand attacked Avidya with a 'mountain-breaking blow' – and felled him to the ground.[84]

With one of their best elephants down for the count and Chitranand charging madly after Gaj Bhaunr through their ranks, with Ali Quli turbanless and Bahadur out of sight, the rebel army began to lose steam.

In the chaos of the losing battle, amid the screams of wounded animals and the scramble of retreating feet, Ali Quli – like Bahadur – was thrown off his horse. As he looked around, in hope of another mount or a helping hand, one of Akbar's elephants approached. This one was called Nainsukh and he was missing a tusk; lost in another war perhaps.

Ali Quli, with not even a turban on his head, was less easily identified. The Uzbek called out to Nainsukh's mahout, 'I am a great leader, take me alive . . .'![85]

Bahadur, meanwhile, had already been captured by Akbar's men, and stood, head bowed, before the padishah. Once, long ago, Akbar's father had laid his head upon the warlord's lap, as Bahadur sang him to sleep. Akbar may have known the story. If not, it was below Bahadur's pride to remind him of it. He would say nothing, indeed, neither in anger nor apology; only, at the end of many questions, 'God is to be praised, whatever happens.'[86]

Abul Fazl says that Akbar did not want to kill him; Badauni adds that Bahadur asked for water, and Akbar gave him his own canteen. Akbar's commanders, on the other hand, wanted blood, and Akbar acquiesced. Two men stepped forward and cut off Bahadur's head.

But what of his brother?

One of the Uzbek's men, now in chains, spoke up. He had seen Ali Quli